

ZYVORAI LABS · CUSTOMER DOCUMENTATION

Chimera

Getting Started

2026-08-29

What you need

- Go 1.25+ to build from source, **or** a `.deb` / `.rpm` from [GitHub Releases](#)
- Browser for Command Center
- Optional: Transiva checkout for end-to-end export smoke

1. Start the engine

```
git clone https://github.com/zyvora/chimera.git
cd chimera
go mod tidy
go build -o bin/chimera ./cmd/chimera
./bin/chimera serve -config config.example.json
```

Or remote install:

```
./scripts/deploy-remote.sh <host> [user]
```

2. Open Command Center

`http://localhost:2999/chimera`

Log in with **admin / admin** (change later in Settings). Without a session the UI shows only the login screen.

3. Confirm the vSphere persona

```
./bin/chimera selftest  
-url http://localhost:8989/sdk  
-user administrator@vsphere.local  
-pass vmware
```

A passing self-test proves auth, inventory, OVF descriptor, `ExportVm`, and NFC lease download.

4. First useful checks in the UI

1. Overview KPIs populate (requests, sessions, exports).
2. Topology shows datacenter → cluster → host → datastore.
3. VM inventory lists simulator VMs (for example `DC0_C0_RP0_VM0`).
4. Scenario Launcher: try **Clean Environment**.

Next

- [Using the Dashboard](#)
 - [Wire Transiva](#)
 - [Admin basics](#)
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Chimera's **Command Center** is a single-page infrastructure console embedded in the Go binary (`internal/gateway/ui.go`). There is no Node/React build step.

Shell layout

Region	Role
Left rail	Provider personas (vSphere active; others roadmap) + health ring
Top bar	Refresh, notifications (jumps to Live requests), Fault Studio gear
Main column	Overview KPIs, topology, activity donut, live requests, VM inventory, VMDK Library, scenarios
Right drawer	Fault Studio (latency, failures, NFC drops, bandwidth)

How to move around

1. Sign in — mutating controls require a dashboard session.
2. Use **Refresh** after scenario or fault changes.
3. Open **View Full Topology** for the zoomable estate map.
4. Filter VMs by name or power state; paginate as needed.
5. Open Fault Studio from the gear icon when you need deterministic failures for Transiva retries.

Empty / fail tips

Symptom	Check
Login loop	Defaults <code>admin / admin</code> ; or values set via Settings / <code>CHIMERA_ADMIN_*</code>
Empty inventory	Simulator counts in config; restart after config changes
No KPI movement	Dashboard polling is excluded from counters — drive traffic via <code>/sdk</code> or Transiva
Self-test fails	URL must be the SDK (<code>/sdk</code>), not <code>/__chimera/</code>

Next: [Page-by-page guides](#) · [Workflows](#)

A. Prove the vSphere contract (self-test)

```
./bin/chimera selftest  
-url http://localhost:8989/sdk  
-user administrator@vsphere.local  
-pass vmware
```

Expect: login → inventory → OVF descriptor → ExportVm → NFC download success.

B. Wire Transiva export

```
./scripts/make-transiva-config.sh > /tmp/transiva-chimera.yaml  
Point Transiva / hyperexport at that config (see docs/TRANSIVA.md)
```

Confirm `vcenter_url` uses Chimera's host (not laptop `127.0.0.1` if Transiva runs elsewhere) and `insecure:`
`true` for lab TLS.

C. Resume / Range download

```
/scripts/scenario_flash_resume
```

Drops the next NFC stream after ~2 MiB so Transiva retries with `Range: bytes=N-` and Chimera returns HTTP 206.

Reset faults from Fault Studio or scenario reset afterwards.

D. Fault injection for client hardening

From Command Center → Fault Studio:

1. Set latency or next-N API failures.
2. Enable NFC stream drop / bandwidth cap.
3. Re-run Transiva export or `selftest` .
4. Clear faults before clean runs.

E. Real VMDK fixtures

1. Stage `.vmdk` files under `fixture_vmdk_dir` (or upload via **VMDK Library**).
2. Optionally pin a file to a VM (Manual fixture badge).
3. Export that VM through Transiva to exercise conversion, not only transfer.

Matching rules: see product-repo `docs/TRANSIVA.md` .